



YOU ARE 11 WEEKS AND 6 DAYS

197 days to go

YOUR BABY TODAY

The bones of the front of the skull have continued to expand and cover the head, protecting the delicate brain structures beneath. The soft spot in between the skull bones (center) remains through pregnancy and into babyhood.

“If you’re finding you’re out of breath when you get to the top of the stairs, accept this as a normal side effect of pregnancy.”

By the end of the first trimester it’s normal to begin feeling a little breathless. This is because your heart and lungs are having to work much harder to supply your body with oxygen due to all the changes that are taking place.

The amount of oxygen you need in pregnancy is about 20 percent more than normal; some of this goes to the [placenta](#) and baby and the rest to your other organs. To get this increased amount of oxygen you breathe faster and deeper, almost hyperventilating so you feel short of breath, especially when you exercise.

This shortness of breath, or feeling that you are not breathing deeply may continue or worsen as the baby grows. Your uterus will expand upward and your other abdominal organs will rearrange themselves to create more room. Your organs and uterus push up against your diaphragm so it becomes more difficult to take a deep breath, so in order to get all the oxygen you need, you then have to breathe much faster. The hormone progesterone may also affect the rate at which you breathe.

If you have any concerns about breathlessness, don’t hesitate to speak to your doctor.